

Juan Pablo Bascur Cifuentes

Contact Information

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Profile

Data Scientist with 10 years of work experience, including 7 years in academia and 3 years in industry. I am passionate about helping people extract valuable insights from data and seek projects where I can both contribute and continue learning. I enjoy collaborating with colleagues and developing innovative solutions. I have experience in deploying machine learning models, deploying web based interactive visualizations, and extracting insights from unstructured data.

Education

PhD in Scientometrics, Leiden University, The Netherlands, 2018 - 2025

- Thesis: Science maps for information retrieval.
- Supervisors: Ludo Waltman, Nees Jan van Eck, Suzan Verberne.
- I developed a prototype of a science map for information retrieval and developed new methods that allow evaluating the quality of such tools in a systematic, high scale and low effort way.

BSc/MSc in Biochemistry, Cum laude, Andrés Bello National University, Chile, 2008 - 2016

- Thesis: Identification of enzyme superfamilies significantly mutated in cancer and characterization of their analogous mutations.
- Supervisor: Daniel Eduardo Almonacid.
- I created a statistical test to identify which superfamilies are significantly mutated in cancer, and I characterized the functional effect of a mutation through an innovative use of binding energies in molecular modeling.

Work experience

Data Scientist, Elsevier B.V., 2026 - ongoing

- Industry position in data analysis, product development and client-facing solution design.
- A major part of my role is developing products for fourth-generation university services.

Data Scientist, Leiden University, 2025 - 2026

- Academic position in a project to create alternative approaches for evaluating research.
- I developed a graphical user interface on Google Cloud for running queries on Open Research Information databases using Google BigQuery.
- I designed two new metrics of university productivity that provided insights qualities that were not visible before: Workforce productivity concentration and workforce internal collaboration.

Teaching Fellow, Leiden University, 2021 - 2026

- Academic position to teach data science courses for Master's students.

Data Scientist, Leiden University and Fondazione Bruno Kessler, 2024 - 2025

- Academic position in a project to study misinformation interactions between tweets and academic documents.

- I developed a metric that allows to evaluate the misinformation surrounding an academic document by connecting it to the unreliability of Twitter users. I also created a dashboard of several maps of misinformation in science that can be accessed online.

Data Scientist, Leiden University and Delft University of Technology, 2021 - 2021

- Academic position in a project to study how social media interacts with academic publications.
- I improved an algorithm of sentiment analysis and created a method to compare the self-organization of academic publications between social media and the scientific community.

Data Scientist, CWTS B.V. www.cwtsbv.nl, 2019 - 2021

- Industry position in a research consultancy company.
- I wrote several scientific performance reports for academic clients.

Data Scientist, WriteWise web.writewise.io, 2017 - 2018

- Industry position in an artificial intelligence company that creates academic writing assistance software.
- I developed and deployed a machine learning based feature of the software, which indicates which words are more frequent in journals of low or high impact factors.

Data Scientist, Andrés Bello National University, 2013 - 2016

- Academic position in a project to predict gene functions and find biological significance.
- I created gene sequence similarity networks to find gene functions, and to visualize the project outcomes for our stakeholders.

Skills

Expertise: Artificial intelligence | Databases | Data science | Information retrieval | Natural Language Processing | Data visualization | Bibliometrics | Scientometrics | Research evaluation | Computational social science | Network science | Bioinformatics | Interdisciplinary research | Research Consultancy | Software Development | Unstructured Data Analysis | Text Analytics | Knowledge Elicitation

Programming: Python | SPARQL | LaTeX | SQL | XML | BASH | GCP | AI assisted programming

Languages: English (Expert) | Spanish (Native) | Dutch (B1)

Personal skills: Social | Reliable | Helpful | Analytical | Goal oriented | Fast learner

Publications

Academic publications: On the use of science maps, characterization of academic productivity, and social dynamics in science and academia.

Software publications: Several open tools for research analysis and bibliometric exploration.

List: <https://jpbascur.com/publications>